C&I HANDBOOK
M.Ed./professional studies

Policies Effective: Fall 2013 –

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WELCOME

Welcome to the Department of Curriculum and Instruction! We are thrilled that you have chosen to be a part of our program. Your admission into this program reflects our confidence in your skills and potential. We are glad that you are here.

C&I Graduate Studies Mission Statement
With adherence to the C&I departmental and CEHD missions:

> *The C&I Graduate Studies mission is to prepare graduate students to provide leadership in education through rigorous scholarship, mindful practice, and responsive service in collaboration with schools and communities.*

This handbook is a guide. However, you will also routinely need to refer to these web pages:

- Graduate School, provides information on degree completion processes, policies, forms
- One Stop Student Services, includes registration, financial services, academic calendars and more
- C&I M.Ed./professional studies Current Student Resources - CI specific forms and information

As other questions arise, be sure to contact the Graduate Studies Coordinator, Director of Graduate Studies (DGS), your adviser, other faculty or staff. Faculty members serve as students' main source of guidance on course selection and other academic or professional matters.

ADMINISTRATION AND MANAGEMENT

Governance
The Department Chair is responsible for leadership of the department and management of resources. The Director of Graduate Studies (DGS) chairs the Graduate Studies Committee and coordinates the administration of the department's graduate programs. S/he communicates and enforces University of Minnesota policies and opportunities.

Graduate Studies Committee
The Graduate Studies Committee includes four additional C&I faculty members and two student representatives (serving 1-2 year terms). The committee addresses policy and programmatic concerns and supports/initiates professional development and social activities. The committee meets monthly during the academic year.

Contact information
Contact information for all C&I faculty and staff is available at on the C&I website.

General info, policies & procedures
You can find a listing of policies governing graduate education at the University of Minnesota here: http://www.grad.umn.edu/deans-office/policies_goverance/index.html

In 2010, the University Senate Committee on Educational Policy (SCEP) charged the Graduate School Policy Review Committee to review and update existing graduate education policies that were previously found in a variety of formats, including the Graduate School catalog and constitution. The committee completed its work in spring 2012. Graduate education policies will continue to be developed and reviewed under the purview of the vice provost and dean of graduate education, in consultation with faculty, staff and student stakeholders. Please contactgepolicy@umn.edu with questions or for more information.

Major and tracks (sub-plans)
All C&I M.Ed./professional studies students are enrolled in the Major: Curriculum and Instruction

Tracks (sub-plans/areas) within the C&I major are selected by students when applying to the program. The tracks are as follows:

- Art Education (M.Ed./professional Studies)
- English Education (M.Ed./professional Studies)
- Learning Technologies (M.Ed./professional Studies)
- Literacy Education (M.Ed./professional Studies)
- Mathematics Education (M.Ed./professional Studies)
- Science Education (M.Ed./professional Studies)
- Second Languages and Cultures Education (M.Ed./professional Studies)

Students wishing to change tracks at the U of M must follow the Change of Status Readmission guidelines.

Supplementary C&I information:

- Annual Progress Reviews for M.Ed./professional studies students are conducted annually. The Graduate Studies Coordinator will review records to ensure that each student has:

- maintained a minimum 2.8 GPA each semester and also a 2.8 cumulative GPA to be considered in good academic standing. All courses must be graded at a "C-" or higher level for satisfactory progress and for degree completion.
- not accumulated more than one course graded "incomplete" on their record

Students falling below academic expectations will result in a Progress Warning notification, with clear expectations delineated for the student to continue in the program. Where students have received an earlier Progress Warning with academic expectations delineated, the student's progress toward meeting these expectations will be evaluated, and the student will be informed about the outcome of the review and any actions that will be taken. This timely and clear communication of the status of the review will also include information about students' due process rights under University policies.

- Students should come to agreement in writing with faculty members on the requirements and deadlines for all "incomplete" grades. Students should refer to the C&I policy on Incomplete Grades and use the "Incomplete Grade Agreement" form: http://www.cehd.umn.edu/ci/Current/MEdProfessional/default.html.
- Students should complete the necessary requirements and submit all necessary forms for degree completion within the timelines stipulated on the Graduate School website and the C&I M.Ed./professional studies Handbook.

When degree requirements and expectations are not met, the DGS will call a joint meeting with the student and the adviser(s) to discuss degree progress and establish clear steps and guidelines for the student. The DGS will follow up with a letter outlining the steps agreed upon in the meeting and indicate a date(s) by which the student is expected to have demonstrated appropriate progress. Consistent failure on the part of the student to meet requirements and expectations will result in a recommendation to the Dean of the Graduate School that the student's status as a graduate student be terminated.

FINANCIAL SUPPORT

Graduate assistantships
Graduate assistantships and loans are the most common forms of graduate student support. Advisers serve as the primary resource for available graduate assistantships in their program area. Within C&I, Ph.D. students are generally given priority for graduate assistantships. We encourage M.Ed./professional studies students to research graduate assistantship opportunities available in other colleges through the Graduate Assistant Employment website: http://www1.umn.edu/ohr/gae/employment/index.html.

College of Education and Human Development Scholarships and Awards
The College of Education and Human Development lists many fellowships and scholarships here: http://www.cehd.umn.edu/current/scholarships/

ADVISING

The adviser acts as the student's major guide and advocate. Upon admission to an M.Ed./professional studies degree program, students are assigned a faculty adviser. This information can be found in the admission letter sent through the ApplyYourself application system.

Students may initiate an adviser change by notifying the present adviser of the intent to change, securing agreement of the new faculty member to serve as adviser, and emailing the Graduate Studies Coordinator (cigs@umn.edu). When you send a change of adviser email, please copy both your current and new adviser to signify approval.

If a conflict develops between a student and his/her adviser, the student should first discuss the problem with the adviser. The DGS may also be consulted as needed. Additional support can be found through the Student Conflict Resolution Center: http://www.sos.umn.edu/. This service offers informal and formal conflict resolution services to resolve students' university-based problems and concerns. An ombudsman provides confidential, neutral and informal options.

INFORMATION & POLICIES

Performance Standards and Progress
Students are responsible for knowing all program requirements for their degree. If requirements change, students may elect to continue under the requirements in effect when they matriculated, provided they have remained in good standing.

GPA/Grade Requirements
Remaining in good academic standing includes meeting the 2.80 (on a 4.00 scale) minimum GPA requirement each semester. Students who fall below the program's minimum GPA requirement may be terminated from the program. Students must have a 2.80 overall GPA for courses included on the degree plan at the time of degree clearance.

Grading Options
A minimum of 2/3 of the course credits included on a degree plan must be taken for a letter grade (A/F). There are certain courses within your program that only offer S/N grading, and these are excluded from the 2/3 requirement calculation. However, it is generally good practice to take courses on the A/F grading scale when it is an option, as A/F grades communicate the quality of your work more accurately.

Continuous Enrollment
Students are required to enroll every regular semester (fall and spring) from the time of matriculation until degree conferral. Failure to do so may result in negative consequences related to academics, visa, financial aid, and other student issues. Contact the Department of Curriculum and Instruction (CIinfo@umn.edu) as soon as possible if you plan to have a break in your degree program.

Registration
Course registration is done online once you have been officially admitted to your program. Specific instructions regarding your classes and/or sections will be provided to Initial Licensure students upon admission. Registration instructions are on the One Stop website: www.onestop.umn.edu/registration/index.html. You must register each term to remain an active student in your program.

Time Limit for Completion
All requirements for the master's degree must be completed and the degree awarded within five calendar years after initial enrollment in the graduate program. Students who are unable to complete the degree within the time limits due to extraordinary circumstances may petition for an extension of up to 12 months. Students must obtain the approval of their faculty adviser by submitting an Academic Policy Petition (see "Petitions" section).

Readmission
Students whose active student status has lapsed and who wish to resume graduate work must seek readmission to their graduate program or to another graduate program. Readmission is not guaranteed, and colleges and programs may add conditions to the readmission (e.g., course grades older than a specified number of years may not be included in the degree plan). Contact the Department of Curriculum and Instruction (CIinfo@umn.edu) for information about how to apply for readmission.

Change of Degree Objective
Currently enrolled graduate students who wish to change or add a degree objective (e.g., change from M.Ed./professional studies program to a M.A. program or simultaneously pursue a Certificate program) must submit the appropriate application within the ApplyYourself application system.

Leave of Absence and Reinstatement
Students may need to interrupt their enrollment for reasons they cannot control. A formal leave of absence provides students the opportunity to return to the University under the rules and policies in effect when they left and without affecting their time to degree. It also allows the University the opportunity to counsel students about actions they must take to be reinstated upon the expiration of the leave. An approved leave of absence may not exceed two academic years, and the time on leave will not be counted toward the time to degree.

You must apply for the leave as well as request a reinstatement when you're ready to return. The policy and links to forms are found here: http://policy.umn.edu/Policies/Education/Education/GRADSTUDENTLEAVE.html (forms under Forms/Instructions section). A signature from your departmental Director of Graduate Studies is required, after consultation with your faculty adviser.

Petitions
There are two petitions used by M.Ed./professional studies students; each is used for specific situations. With either petition, you will be notified through your U of MN email regarding the final decision.

The Graduate Registration Exception Request: Used for all registration-related issues such as adding or cancelling a course after the deadline, swapping courses, changing a grade basis, add or reduce credit load requirements, register for more than 18 credits per term, or other extenuating circumstances. The form is located on One Stop's Graduate Student Resources page (under "Policies & Exceptions" heading): http://onestop.umn.edu/special_for/graduate_students.html. Once submitted, the form will be routed to the appropriate instructor/department for review and decision.

Academic Policy Petition: Used for requesting acceptance of transfer credits, extension to the time limit for completing program, and course substitutions for degree requirements. The form is located on the One Stop forms website: www.onestop.umn.edu/forms/index.html (under the Registration Forms section).
This form is only in a paper version (not electronic) so it will need to be filled out and printed. Obtain departmental and/or faculty recommendations as appropriate for the petition type and attach any necessary documentation.

For requests to have coursework from outside institutions applied to your degree plan, you must have an official transcript (original in a sealed envelope) attached to the petition. If your faculty adviser needs to review your transcript before signing off on the departmental recommendation, please ask them to sign the back of the official transcript envelope verifying that it was sealed at the point of review, and include this signed envelope and the transcript with your petition.

Email
Your University-assigned student email account (@umn.edu) is the official means of communication from the University and CEHD. Check your University-assigned email account regularly. Failure to do so may result in missing information vital to your success in the program. It is possible to forward your University email to another account (for example: hotmail, yahoo, etc.); however, you risk losing important information due to provider spam settings. If you choose to forward email to a personal account, you are still responsible for all information sent to your University email address, including attachments.

Name Change
Students who change their name, address, or other personal information during the course of their program are responsible for notifying the University. In order to request an official change with the University, students must submit the appropriate University forms, including the Name Change Request or Notice of Address Change forms, available online: http://onestop.umn.edu/forms/index.html. Students must also notify the Department of Curriculum and Instruction (CIinfo@umn.edu) of any name change.

Scholastic Dishonesty / Plagiarism
Academic integrity is essential to a positive teaching and learning environment. All students enrolled in University courses are expected to complete coursework responsibilities with fairness and honesty. Failure to do so by seeking unfair advantage over others or misrepresenting someone else's work as your own, can result in disciplinary action. The University Student Conduct Code, available on the Office of Student Conduct and Academic Integrity (OSCAI) website: www.oscai.umn.edu/index.html, defines scholastic dishonesty as follows:

Scholastic dishonesty means plagiarizing; cheating on assignments or examinations; engaging in unauthorized collaboration on academic work; taking, acquiring, or using test materials without faculty permission; submitting false or incomplete records of academic achievement; acting alone or in cooperation with another to falsify records or to obtain dishonestly grades, honors, awards, or professional endorsement; altering forging , or misusing a University academic record; or fabricating or falsifying data, research procedures, or data analysis.

Plagiarism is defined as representing the words, creative work, or ideas of another person as one's own without providing proper documentation of source. Examples include, but are not limited to:

- Copying information word for word from a source without using quotation marks and giving proper acknowledgement by way of footnote, endnote, or in-text citation;
- Representing the words, ideas, or data of another person as one's own without providing proper attribution to the author through quotation, reference, in-text citation, or footnote;
- Producing, without proper attribution, any form of work originated by another person such as a musical phrase, a proof, a speech, an image, experimental data, laboratory report, graphic design, or computer code;
- Paraphrasing, without sufficient acknowledgment, ideas taken from another person that the reader might reasonably mistake as the author's; and
- Borrowing various words, ideas, phrases, or data from original sources and blending them with one's own without acknowledging the sources.

It is the responsibility of all students to understand the standards and methods of proper attribution and to clarify with each instructor the standards, expectations, and reference techniques appropriate to the subject area and class requirements, including group work and internet use. Students are encouraged to seek out information about these methods from instructors and other resources and to apply this information in all submissions of academic work.

If you are confronted with allegations of misconduct, the University has a process in place to resolve the issue. Review the Discipline Process outlined under the Student Information section of the OSCAI website for detailed information. You can also obtain the assistance of an ombudsman through the Student Conflict Resolution Center (www.sos.umn.edu/) to help you through the process.

Note: OSCAI does not assist with academic performance issues. Review the Conflict Resolution/Grievance Process for more information about resolving those disputes.

Conflict Resolution / Grievance Process
If you have a dispute, the first step of any resolution should be at the lowest unit level, between the parties involved or the parties and an appropriate third party (e.g., other faculty, program coordinator, or student services adviser). Students may wish to contact the Student Conflict Resolution Center (www.sos.umn.edu/) or similar support services for advice and possible mediation. If no informal resolution is reached at the lowest unit level, a student may seek informal resolution at the collegiate level with the other party and higher level administrators. If the issue is not resolved informally, the student may seek formal resolution. Information about filing a formal grievance is found on the Office for Student Conduct and Academic Integrity website: http://www.oscai.umn.edu/.

Sexual Harassment Policy
"Sexual Harassment" means unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and/or other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature. Such conduct has the purpose or effect of unreasonably interfering with an individual's work or academic performance or creating an intimidating, hostile, or offensive working or academic environment in any University activity or program. Such behavior is not acceptable in the University setting. For additional information, please consult Board of Regents Policy: http://regents.umn.edu/sites/default/files/policies/SexHarassment.pdf.

Access to Educational Records
In accordance with University of Minnesota Board of Regents' policies on access to student records, information about a student may not be released to a third party without the student's permission. Exceptions under the law include state and federal educational and financial aid institutions. Some student information – name, address, email, telephone number, dates of enrollment and enrollment status (full-time, part-time, not enrolled, withdrawn, and date of withdrawal), college and class, major, adviser, academic awards and honors received, and degrees earned – is considered public or directory information. Students may prevent the release of public information by notifying the records office on their campus. Students have the right to review their educational records and to challenge the contents of those records.

COURSEWORK

Transfer credits
M.Ed./professional studies students may transfer a maximum of 12 graduate semester credits to the M.Ed./ professional studies program. Credits may include any combination of the following coursework:

- Graduate semester credits from fully accredited institutions other than the University of Minnesota
- Credits completed at the University of Minnesota before admission to the M.Ed. program

You must complete coursework at the graduate level, and a faculty adviser and the college must approve the courses before they can be applied. Workshop credits are usually not accepted for transfer to C&I programs. Contact the program's faculty adviser for more information.

Filing the Graduate Degree Plan
Students work with advisers in planning their programs. Students must submit the Graduate Degree Plan form the semester before they intend to graduate.

The Graduate Degree Plan form includes a list of the coursework for the degree and also asks students to identify their Master's plan. M.Ed./professional studies students should select Plan C.

GRADUATION & COMMENCEMENT

CEHD Commencement
CEHD's commencement ceremony is held once per year in May. All students are notified early in spring term about the process for signing up for commencement. Additional information is available at: http://www.cehd.umn.edu/commencement/default.html.

Please note: participating in commencement does not mean that you are, or will be, cleared for graduation. Graduation clearance is a separate process.

Clearance for graduation
Degrees are awarded monthly. To qualify for graduation in a particular month, a student must submit the Application for Degree form on or before the first workday of that month.